

N10 FOOD PREPARATION | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Provide space and supportive amenities for the preparation of meals on-site.

Summary : This WELL feature requires a food preparation area, storage space and other amenities to support the reassembly or reheating of meals on-site.

Issue : Consumption of foods away from home has steadily increased since the 1970s.¹ This is a concerning trend, since meals consumed away from home are often higher in calories, lower in nutrients and larger in portion size.² Emerging research has found an association between eating away from home and a higher BMI and lower fruit and vegetable consumption in adults.³ Analysis of dietary intake data also shows that individuals who bring food from home tend to have a better diet quality than individuals who purchase food away from home.² In addition to nutritional benefits, preparing meals at home has financial benefits. Frequent home cooking is linked to reduced food expenditures, whereas frequently eating away from home is associated with higher food expenditures.⁴

Solutions : Spaces that allow individuals to reheat or assemble food prepared at home can support healthy eating habits and cooking skills. Sufficient cold storage space can ensure safe food storage to accommodate the storage needs of individuals who bring meals from home. Other supportive amenities, such as eating utensils and devices for reheating food can make it even easier for individuals to consume homemade meals and encourage healthy eating patterns.

PART 1 PROVIDE MEAL SUPPORT (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units, Commercial Kitchen Spaces & Guest Rooms:

The following supportive amenities are provided in a quantity that meets employee demand in at least one dedicated eating area within a 200 m walk distance of the project boundary:

- a. Cold storage.
- b. Countertop surface.
- c. Sink and amenities for dish and hand washing.
- d. Device for reheating food (e.g., toaster oven, microwave).
- e. Dedicated cabinets or storage units available for employee use.
- f. Non-plastic plates, bowls and cups.
- g. Spoons, forks and knives.
- h. Cans/bins for garbage, recycling and/or compost.

For Dwelling Units:

The following supportive amenities are provided:

- a. Countertop surface.
- b. Sink.
- c. Refrigerator.
- d. Cabinets.
- e. Stove with hood vented directly to the outdoors.

For Guest Rooms:

The following are available for guest use in each guestroom:

- a. Refrigerator/mini-fridge (not counting refrigerators dedicated to items that can be purchased).
- b. Microwave oven.
- c. Bowls, cups and utensils, including spoons, forks and knives.
- d. Dish soap.

REFERENCES

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2. Todd JE, Mancino L, Lin B-H. The Impact of Food Away from Home on Adult Diet Quality. Ssrn. 2010. doi:10.2139/ssrn.1557129
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